

# A Comprehensive Taxonomic Analysis of the Entomo-Morphological Diversity in the Hallownest Ecosystem

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## Abstract

The subterranean kingdom of Hallownest presents a unique biological paradigm, characterized by highly specialized insectoid life forms and anomalous metaphysical influences. This paper provides a systematic taxonomic classification of the kingdom's inhabitants, categorized by physiological traits, neurological susceptibility to the *Radiant* infection, and the emergence of synthetic, void-based constructs. We examine the divergent evolution of the Mantis tribe, the fungal-insectoid symbiotes of the Fungal Wastes, and the artificial phylogeny of the Kingsmoulds and Vessels. Our findings suggest that the Hallownest ecosystem is not merely a product of natural selection but has been significantly reshaped by divine and abyssal interventions.

## 1 Introduction

The ecological landscape of Hallownest is defined by its verticality and the pervasive presence of the "Pale King's" influence, which historically catalyzed a transition from feral instinct to higher cognition in many species. However, the subsequent

collapse of this civilization due to the *Radiance* (a psychotropic parasitic entity) has led to a fascinating, albeit tragic, regression in taxonomic stability.

This study aims to reconcile the disparate biological data collected from the Hunter's Journal and the archives of the Teacher's Archives to establish a rigorous framework for Hallownestian zoology.

## 2 Taxonomic Hierarchies

Life in Hallownest can be broadly divided into four primary clades based on their origin and metaphysical resonance.

### 2.1 Arthropoda      Civilis (Higher Insects)

This clade includes species that attained or maintained higher consciousness during the King's era.

- **Coleoptera Sapiens:** The Great Knights and the Beetles of the Crossroads.
- **Mantodea Independis:** The Mantis Tribe, notable for their resistance to the infection through sheer willpower and isolationism.
- **Araneae Profundis:** The inhabitants of Deepnest, characterized by complex

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social structures and extreme predatory efficiency.

## 2.2 Myco-Insecta (Symbiotic Entities)

Predominantly found in the Fungal Wastes, these organisms represent a fusion of insectoid hosts and fungal mycelium. Species such as the *Shrumal Warrior* exhibit a collective consciousness facilitated by spore-based communication.

## 2.3 Vasis Inanitatis (Void-Based Constructs)

The most anomalous category involves entities derived from the Abyss. These are not biological in the traditional sense but are animated by “Void” contained within a calcified shell.

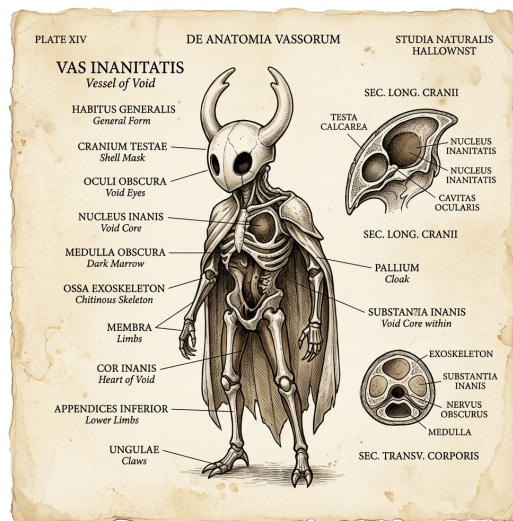


Figure 1: Anatomical cross-section of a *Vasis Inanitatis* specimen, showing the integration of Void-matter within a chitinous mask.

## 3 The Pathophysiology of the Infection

The *Radiance* manifests as a luminous crystallization within the nervous system. From

a taxonomic perspective, an infected specimen should be viewed as a “composite organism,” where the host’s biological functions are subverted to serve the spread of the parasite. This often results in hypertrophic mutations, such as the bloated abdomens of the *Exploding Vengefly*.

## 4 Methodology of Observation

Specimens were observed in their natural habitats, ranging from the humid Greenpath to the crystalline peaks of Crystal Mound. Data was cross-referenced with the Hunter’s Journal, prioritizing morphological traits such as number of limbs, mandibular structure, and response to Soul-based stimuli.

## 5 Case Study: The Mantis Tribe

The Mantis Tribe offers a unique control group for studying the Infection. Unlike their peers in the City of Tears, the Mantis Lords rejected the light, maintaining their predatory hierarchy. Their morphology—characterized by elongated, scythe-like forelimbs—indicates a lineage that has remained unchanged for eons, predating the Pale King’s arrival.

## 6 Conclusion

The taxonomy of Hallownest is a record of both natural beauty and metaphysical disaster. As the Void continues to reclaim the lower reaches and the Light fades from the upper peaks, the boundaries between these species remain fluid. Future research must focus on the genomic potential of the Unnsentient life in Greenpath to understand the resilience of biological life against external deific influences.

## References

- [1] The Hunter. *The Hunter's Journal: A Complete Guide to the Creatures of Hallownest*. Hallownest Press, Year 0 (Pre-Collapse).
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